

The 10 Claude Connectors I'd Actually Turn On

Most people use Claude like a smarter text box. Connectors are how you turn it into an assistant that works inside the tools where your job already happens.

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Here's how most people use Claude: ask a question, get an answer, copy it somewhere else. That works. It's also the beginner version — you're doing all the fetching and filing by hand, and Claude is flying blind on everything you didn't paste in.

Connectors close that gap. A connector is a bridge between Claude and another app — Gmail, your calendar, your docs, Slack, your task tracker, your codebase. Instead of you copying context in, Claude reaches into the source and pulls it out. In a lot of cases it can take action too: draft the reply, create the task, make the page.

One thing worth knowing before you connect anything: connectors inherit *your* permissions. If you can't open a file, channel, or record in the original app, Claude can't see it through the connector either. It's not a skeleton key. It's your own badge, handed to a very fast assistant.

The real unlock isn't that Claude gets smarter in some abstract way. It's that Claude finally gets **context** — and context is the whole game. Below: the ten connectors I'd actually turn on, a copy-paste prompt for each, five workflows to try this week, and the warnings nobody mentions up front.

THE MENTAL MODEL

Claude without connectors is a genius locked in an empty room.

Picture hiring a brilliant consultant and then locking them in an empty conference room. No inbox, no calendar, no docs, no customer threads, no files. They're sharp, but they can't see a single thing about how your work actually runs — so the best they can do is talk in generalities.

Connectors hand that consultant a badge and a laptop. Now they can read the thread, check the calendar, find the doc, and turn the follow-up into a task. Claude doesn't suddenly know everything — it can finally see *the work*. That's the entire difference between "write me a generic email" and "answer this specific person, given everything that's already been said."

THE ONE IDEA TO HOLD ONTO

Connectors remove the copy-paste layer between your tools and your brain. That layer is where most of your wasted time actually lives — the fetching, the digging, the "I know we wrote this down somewhere."

THE LINEUP

Ten connectors, one ready-to-paste prompt each

01 — Gmail

Turn your inbox into an action list

Email is where half of modern work quietly hides. The Gmail connector lets Claude search threads, summarize the long ones, surface what you actually owe people, and draft replies in your voice. It writes drafts — it won't hit send for you, which is exactly the guardrail you want. Most people don't have an inbox problem. They have a *hidden-obligations* problem, and this is the fix.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Search my Gmail from the last 7 days and build a prioritized list of anything I need to reply to, follow up on, or decide. Group it into urgent / important / low priority, and draft replies for the top 3.

02 — Google Calendar

See the week before the week eats you alive

Your calendar isn't a schedule — it's a map of what everyone else is taking from your time. Claude can read it, find your open blocks, flag where you're overcommitted, prep you for meetings, and create or move events. Use it to plan the week instead of just surviving it.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Look at my calendar for this week. Tell me where I'm overcommitted, where I have deep-work time, and what meetings I should prep for. Then build a Monday plan that protects at least two focus blocks.

03 — Google Drive

Make the junk drawer searchable

Drive is where the "I swear we wrote this down somewhere" problem lives. Claude can search across Docs, Sheets, Slides, PDFs, and Office files, pull the relevant ones, and synthesize what's in them. One catch: it reads the text, not images baked inside documents. Drive is useful right up until it becomes a junk drawer — this is what makes it useful again.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Search my Drive for anything related to [project name]. Summarize the key decisions, open questions, owners, deadlines, and any risks that show up across the docs.

04 — Notion

Turn messy thinking into durable systems

Claude is great at thinking *with* you. Notion is great at storing the output so it doesn't die in a chat thread. Connect the two and a sprawling conversation becomes a structured page — SOPs, research libraries, content calendars, internal docs — read and written based on your workspace permissions.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Take this conversation and turn it into a Notion page called "Claude Connector Workflow Ideas." Organize it into sections, put a checklist at the top, and add a "next experiments" section with 5 things to test this week.

05 — Slack

Find the work hiding in team conversations

Slack is where important decisions go to disappear — distributed across 400 messages and one person's memory. Claude can summarize a channel, surface the decisions that got buried, pull out action items, and turn a messy thread into a clean brief. Your team probably *does* have documentation. It's just trapped in scrollback.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Search Slack for messages about [project / customer / initiative] from the last two weeks. Summarize the decisions made, blockers mentioned, people involved, and anything that needs follow-up.

06 — Asana

Turn the guilt museum into a plan

Every task system eventually becomes a guilt museum — a wall of things you meant to do. Claude can read your Asana, tell you what's actually overdue versus what just looks scary, flag what's blocked or delegable, and create new tasks. It's good at converting a vague pile into a short, honest plan.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Review my Asana tasks for this week. Tell me what's overdue, what's blocked, what can be delegated, and what should be moved. Then build a clean priority plan for the next 3 workdays.

07 — Linear

Where engineering reality lives

Linear is the connector for PMs, engineers, and founders moving work through a software team. Claude can read open issues, group bugs by likely root cause, spot duplicates, and create new issues ("file a bug for the login error"). Admins can keep it read-only if you'd rather it look but not touch. Think of it as a translator between engineering reality and everyone who needs to understand it.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Look through Linear for open bugs related to [feature]. Group them by likely root cause, flag duplicates, and draft a proposed engineering plan with priorities.

08 — GitHub

Read the codebase without spelunking

GitHub is where the actual product lives, which makes it one of the highest-leverage connectors for technical users. Claude can search the repo, explain how a system works in plain English, point at the key files, and tell you where you'd need to change things. For engineers it's a senior dev who's already read the whole map. For everyone else, it's a way to understand what's happening without pulling a developer off their work to explain it.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Search the repo for how authentication is implemented. Explain the flow in plain English, name the key files, and tell me where I'd likely need to make changes to add [new feature].

09 — Canva

From "here's the idea" to "here's something publishable"

For creators, marketers, and founders, Canva shortens the path from concept to asset — social posts, decks, thumbnails, lead magnets. Most people don't need a full-time designer for every little thing. They need a fast route from an idea to something good enough to ship, and this is it.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Create three Instagram carousel concepts from this guide. Make each one beginner-friendly and punchy, aimed at someone who's heard of Claude but has never touched a connector.

10 — Higgsfield

A production assistant for image and video

This is the one people sleep on. Higgsfield turns Claude into a production assistant for image and video generation — reaching 30+ models, picking one, setting the parameters, running the generation, and dropping finished creative back into the chat. Claude handles the strategy and structure; Higgsfield makes the actual pixels. Idea → brief → asset, without bouncing across a dozen tabs.

TRY THIS PROMPT

Create 5 short-form video concepts for this connectors guide. For each: the hook, visual direction, a shot list, and a prompt for generating a 9:16 video asset.

START HERE

Don't connect everything at once

Begin with the tools that hold your real context.

If you're brand new to connectors, resist the urge to flip on all of them. Start with the five apps that contain the most useful personal and work context. That alone is enough to build genuinely powerful workflows — inbox, schedule, documents, knowledge base, team chat, and your task list, all visible to Claude at once.

MY RECOMMENDED STARTER STACK

1. Gmail — your inbox 2. Google Calendar — your schedule 3. Google Drive — your documents 4. Notion or Slack — knowledge + team conversations 5. One task system — Asana, Linear, Jira, or your equivalent

FIVE WORKFLOWS

Stack connectors together and try these today

1. The Monday Morning Brief

Gmail + Calendar + Slack + Asana/Linear

PROMPT

Build my Monday morning briefing. Check my email, calendar, Slack, and task system. Tell me what changed since Friday, what needs my attention, what meetings I need to prep for, and what I should do first today.

2. The Meeting Prep Assistant

Calendar + Gmail + Drive + Notion

PROMPT

I have a meeting with [person / company / team]. Pull together a prep brief from my calendar event, recent emails, related docs, and notes. Include background, likely topics, unresolved decisions, and questions I should ask.

3. The Inbox Triage System

Gmail + Calendar

PROMPT

Review my unread emails from the last 72 hours. Tell me what needs a reply, what can be archived, what should become a task, and what needs calendar time. Draft replies where it makes sense.

4. The Project Catch-Up

Slack + Notion + Linear/Asana + Drive

PROMPT

Catch me up on [project]. Look across Slack, docs, tasks, and notes. Summarize the current status, recent decisions, blockers, owners, and next actions.

5. The Content Repurposing Machine

Notion + Google Drive + Canva/Higgsfield

PROMPT

Take this document and turn it into a short-form content package: 5 hooks, 3 reel scripts, 1 carousel outline, 1 caption, and 3 visual creative directions.

BEFORE YOU GO WILD

Four things nobody tells you up front

01 — Connectors touch real data. Choose deliberately.

The power and the risk are the same thing: connectors reach into live systems. Don't wire up a tool just because it's in the directory. Be especially careful with email, customer data, financial records, HR systems, and private company docs. In a company setting, Team and Enterprise owners can restrict what Claude is allowed to do — like blocking it from sending messages or editing files. Use those controls.

02 — Read-only is usually enough.

You rarely need Claude to be able to change everything. For most workflows, "search and summarize" is already a massive win — and it's far lower-stakes. If you're rolling this out at work, start read-only wherever you can and expand only when a workflow actually needs write access.

03 — More connectors isn't better. It's noisier.

Connecting 30 tools doesn't get you smarter answers — it gives Claude more to wade through. If you've got ten or more active, switch tool access to "On demand" so each conversation has room to breathe and Claude only reaches for what the task in front of it actually needs.

04 — Always ask for the sources.

When Claude pulls from Gmail, Calendar, or Drive, it can cite exactly which emails, events, or documents it used — often with links straight to the originals. Ask for those citations every time. The point was never just to get an answer. It's to know where the answer came from, so you can trust it or check it.

The Big Idea

Connectors aren't just "integrations." They're the difference between asking AI to *imagine* your work and asking it to help with your *actual* work. Generic Claude can write a decent email. Connected Claude can read the thread, understand the context, check your calendar, find the doc, draft the reply, and turn the follow-up into a task.

That's why this matters — not because it's flashy, but because it deletes the copy-paste layer between your tools and your brain. Start with five connectors, run one of the workflows above this week, and ask for your sources. That's the whole on-ramp.

Want more ways to get the most out of Claude?

Follow along on Instagram for weekly breakdowns.

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